LESSON 4

Experiencing God's Love

Primary Scripture: 1 John 1:5–10

Supporting Scriptures: Romans 5:8; Psalm 32:1–5; Proverbs 28:13; Romans 8:1

Memory Verse: 1 John 1:9

Central Teaching Truth

God's love is demonstrated through Jesus Christ. Honest confession, repentance, and faith in Christ allow believers to enjoy restored fellowship with God.

Lesson Objective

Understand God's unchanging love, recognize how sin affects fellowship with Him, and practice confession and repentance.

Introduction

A Christian may genuinely love God yet struggle with repeated failures. Shame may tempt us to withdraw from prayer and fellowship. Our confidence, however, rests in what Jesus Christ accomplished on the cross—not in perfect performance.

1 | OBSERVATION — Read It

Read 1 John 1:5–10.

1. What does John say about God's nature in verse 5?

_____

_____

2. What is the difference between walking in darkness and walking in the light?

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_____

3. What is wrong with claiming that we have no sin?

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_____

4. What does verse 9 promise when we confess our sins?

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2 | INTERPRETATION — Understand It

God is light. He is perfectly holy, righteous, and truthful. His children are called to live according to His truth.

Sin affects fellowship. Confession is not a way to purchase God's love; it is an honest response to His holiness and grace.

Christ is our advocate. According to 1 John 2:1–2, forgiveness rests upon Christ's sacrifice, not our worthiness.

Repentance involves change. Confession acknowledges sin, while repentance includes turning away from it.

3 | APPLICATION — Live It

5. Is there a sin I have avoided acknowledging before God?

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_____

6. How can Christ's forgiveness change the way I respond to guilt?

_____

_____

7. Is there someone I should approach to seek forgiveness or make restitution?

_____

_____

Personal Action Step

This week read Psalm 32:1–5. Confess known sin to God, give thanks for His mercy in Christ, and take one appropriate step toward changed behavior.

Group Discussion

How does the Spirit's conviction, which leads toward repentance, differ from hopeless condemnation?

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Closing Prayer

Father, thank You for loving us while we were still sinners. Help us walk in Your light, confess honestly, and live in grateful obedience to Jesus Christ. Amen.

LESSON 5

Developing Our Relationship with God

Primary Scripture: Psalm 32:8

Supporting Scriptures: Mark 1:35; Psalm 1:1–3; John 15:4–5; Colossians 3:16; Philippians 4:6–7

Memory Verse: Psalm 32:8

Central Teaching Truth

Our relationship with God grows as we seek Him through Scripture, prayer, obedience, and fellowship with other believers.

Lesson Objective

Develop a consistent devotional life that strengthens knowledge of God and encourages spiritual maturity.

Introduction

Meaningful relationships develop through communication, trust, and time. God already knows us fully, yet invites us to know Him more deeply through His Word and prayer. Jesus regularly made time to pray to the Father.

1 | OBSERVATION — Read It

Read Mark 1:35 and Psalm 1:1–3.

1. When and where did Jesus spend time praying?

_____

_____

2. What does the person in Psalm 1 delight in?

_____

_____

3. What does the image of a well-watered tree teach us?

_____

_____

4. According to Psalm 32:8, what does God promise?

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2 | INTERPRETATION — Understand It

God's Word develops understanding. Scripture reveals His character, will, promises, and instructions for righteous living.

Prayer expresses dependence. We worship, confess, give thanks, seek wisdom, and bring our concerns to God.

Obedience demonstrates love. John 14:21 connects loving Christ with keeping His commandments.

Consistency encourages growth. A devotional routine cannot earn salvation, but regular attention to Scripture and prayer cultivates maturity.

A Simple Devotional Pattern

Practice	What to do
Read	Read a short Bible passage thoughtfully.
Observe	Notice what the passage actually says.
Understand	Consider context and intended meaning.
Pray	Respond to God in prayer.
Obey	Identify one truth to put into practice.

3 | APPLICATION — Live It

5. What distractions most often interrupt my time with God?

_____

_____

6. How can I pursue God without making devotion an empty routine?

_____

_____

Personal Action Step

For the next seven days, choose a regular time and place for prayer and Scripture. My time: _____ My place: _____ My Bible book: _____

Group Discussion

What prevents consistent time with God, and what practical change could help?

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Closing Prayer

Heavenly Father, give us a hunger for Your Word and a desire to seek You in prayer. Teach us to trust and obey You every day. Amen.

LESSON 6

Power for Living

Primary Scripture: Ephesians 5:18

Supporting Scriptures: John 14:16–17; John 16:13–14; Acts 1:8; Romans 8:9–14; Galatians 5:16–25

Memory Verse: Ephesians 5:18

Central Teaching Truth

The Holy Spirit enables believers to grow in holiness, resist sinful desires, understand truth, and witness to Jesus Christ.

Lesson Objective

Understand who the Holy Spirit is, recognize His work, and learn to walk under His direction.

Introduction

Many Christians try to live faithfully through determination alone and become discouraged when they fail. God has given His people the Holy Spirit to empower spiritual growth and service.

1 | OBSERVATION — Read It

Read Ephesians 5:18–21.

1. What command does Paul give in verse 18?

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2. What contrast does Paul make between drunkenness and being filled with the Spirit?

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3. What attitudes or behaviors are described in verses 19–21?

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4. How is a Spirit-filled life reflected in relationships?

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2 | INTERPRETATION — Understand It

The Holy Spirit is God. He is not an impersonal force. Scripture describes Him teaching, guiding, interceding, and exercising His will.

He dwells in believers. Romans 8:9 connects belonging to Christ with having His Spirit.

He leads us toward obedience. Being filled with the Spirit means allowing His direction to shape our thinking, words, and actions.

He produces spiritual fruit. Galatians 5:22–23 lists qualities such as love, joy, patience, kindness, and self-control.

He glorifies Christ. The Spirit draws attention to Jesus and helps believers honor Him.

3 | APPLICATION — Live It

5. Where am I relying chiefly on my own strength?

_____

_____

6. Which fruit of the Spirit needs greater development in my life?

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_____

7. What should I do when sinful desires conflict with God's Word?

_____

_____

Personal Action Step

Read Galatians 5:16–25 this week. Each morning ask God to help you walk by His Spirit. Choose one fruit of the Spirit and practice it intentionally in your relationships.

Group Discussion

What is the difference between depending on the Holy Spirit and trying to live the Christian life by personal effort alone?

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Closing Prayer

Father, thank You for giving us the Holy Spirit. Help us submit to Your Word, turn from sin, and demonstrate the character of Jesus Christ. Amen.

Review of Lessons 4–6

Lesson 4: God's love leads us toward confession and repentance.
Lesson 5: We grow through Scripture, prayer, and obedience.
Lesson 6: The Holy Spirit empowers us to honor Christ.

How do these three lessons fit together in everyday Christian living?

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